AI Usage and Impact on Students and Professionals: Analysis Report

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Scope: 288 respondents (151 students, 137 professionals) across 12 countries
Document type: Analytical summary with findings, interpretation and recommendations

1. Executive Summary

This report summarizes the analysis of a survey dataset describing how students and professionals use AI tools and what they gain from them. The workbook contains one raw data sheet of 288 records and five analysis sheets (pivot tables and charts covering demographics, usage patterns, productivity and time saved). The workbook's figures were reviewed and checked against a fresh recalculation of the raw data.

The five most important findings are:

1. **AI use is widespread and moderate in intensity.** Respondents use AI for an average of 2.9 hours per day (median 2.0 hours). Half of all respondents use it for 2 hours or less.
2. **The benefits are real but modest on average.** Average productivity is 5.2 out of 10, satisfaction is 6.1 out of 10, and the average respondent saves 5.8 hours per week. Across all respondents with data, this adds up to about 1,615 hours saved per week.
3. **How much people use AI matters far more than which tool they use.** Daily usage hours show a strong relationship with time saved (correlation 0.78) and productivity (0.66). Differences between the major tools are small.
4. **Accuracy is the main weak point.** The average accuracy rating is 3.4 out of 5, and about half of respondents rate it 3 or lower. Accuracy is the factor most closely tied to satisfaction apart from productivity itself.
5. **Spending more does not buy better results.** Paying for AI shows no relationship with productivity, time saved or satisfaction. Free users report slightly higher productivity than paying users.

In brief, we recommend helping light users build deeper and more regular AI habits, prioritizing writing, office and research workflows where gains are largest, building verification habits to address accuracy concerns, avoiding paid-tier spending without a role-specific case, and fixing data collection so future analysis is more reliable.

2. Data and Method

The analysis used the raw data sheet (19 fields per respondent, including demographics, tool, purpose, daily usage hours, monthly cost, productivity score, accuracy rating, satisfaction score, time saved per week, and willingness to recommend). The existing pivot tables in the workbook were reviewed, then the raw data was cleaned and re-analyzed so that results are not distorted by inconsistent labels.

Cleaning steps applied for this report:

- Tool names were merged into one label each (for example "Chat GPT", "chatgpt" and "ChatGPT" became ChatGPT; "Google Gemini" and "Gemini" became Gemini; "Microsoft Copilot" and "Copilot" became Copilot).
- Country names were standardized for capitalization (for example "india" and "India").
- Averages were calculated only on records that contain a value, so blanks do not lower results.
- Relationships between measures were tested using correlation coefficients, where values near 1 indicate a strong link and values near 0 indicate none.

Scores for productivity and satisfaction are on a 10-point scale and accuracy is on a 5-point scale, as recorded by respondents. Currency for income and AI cost is not stated in the file, so these are reported as recorded.

3. Key Findings

3.1 Who is in the dataset

- **Respondents:** 288 in total, split between students (151, 52%) and professionals (137, 48%).
- **Age:** The average age is 30.1 and the median is 27. Students average 22.7 years and professionals 38.0 years. The most common ages are 20 to 24.
- **Gender:** 145 male (50%), 119 female (41%), 15 other or non-binary, and 9 not stated.
- **Countries:** India (43), United States (34), Canada (31), Pakistan (28), United Kingdom (26), Brazil (26), Philippines (24), Australia (20), Nigeria (17), Germany (13), France (10) and Kenya (6). Ten records have no country.
- **Income:** The median monthly income is about 524. Professionals have a median of about 1,884 and students about 126.

3.2 How AI is being used

Tools. ChatGPT dominates with 119 users (41%), followed by Gemini (39), Copilot (33), Claude (31), Perplexity (23), Grammarly (14), Meta AI (10) and DeepSeek (9). Ten records have no tool recorded. Students and professionals choose tools in very similar proportions.

Purposes. Coding is the most common purpose (65 users, 23%), followed by writing (49), studying (39), research (38), content creation (28), data analysis (25), customer support (20) and office work (11). The split by group is clear:

Purpose	Students	Professionals
Coding	28	37
Writing	29	20
Research	27	11
Studying	39	0
Data analysis	7	18
Customer support	0	20
Office work	0	11

Intensity. Average use is 2.9 hours per day. Students use AI slightly more (3.0 hours) than professionals (2.9 hours). Only one respondent reports an extreme figure of 23 hours a day, which is treated as a data error (see Section 6).

3.3 Productivity, accuracy and satisfaction

Measure	Average
Productivity score (out of 10)	5.2
Satisfaction score (out of 10)	6.1
Accuracy rating (out of 5)	3.4
Time saved per week	5.8 hours (median 5.0)

Students and professionals report almost identical productivity (5.2 and 5.3), accuracy and satisfaction. Students report somewhat more time saved (6.0 hours a week against 5.6 hours). Time saved equals roughly 14% of a typical five-day working or studying week, assuming the recorded daily hours apply to five days.

3.4 Heavier use goes with larger gains

The table below groups respondents by daily AI usage.

Daily AI use	Respondents	Productivity (of 10)	Satisfaction (of 10)	Time saved per week
1 hour or less	51	3.5	5.3	2.0 hours
1 to 2 hours	90	4.3	5.5	3.8 hours
2 to 4 hours	70	5.6	6.4	6.0 hours
4 to 6 hours	46	7.0	7.0	9.5 hours
More than 6 hours	24	7.8	7.8	14.0 hours

This is the clearest pattern in the data. Usage hours correlate strongly with time saved (0.78) and with productivity (0.66), and productivity correlates with satisfaction (0.66). About half of respondents (141 of 281) sit in the two lowest usage bands, which is where the gains are smallest.

3.5 Results by purpose

- **Highest time savings:** Office work (7.3 hours a week, 11 respondents) and writing (7.0 hours, 49 respondents). Both also rank among the highest for productivity.
- **Lowest results among named purposes:** Coding shows the lowest productivity (4.9) and satisfaction (5.8), even though it is the most common use. Customer support shows the lowest time saved (4.8 hours).
- **Research** users have the highest daily usage (3.7 hours) and the highest satisfaction among purposes (6.4).

3.6 Results by tool

Average productivity ranges only from 5.1 to 5.5 among the larger tools (Copilot 5.5, Claude 5.3, ChatGPT 5.2, Gemini 5.1), with Perplexity lower at 4.6. Given a typical spread of about 1.8 points between individuals, these gaps are small. Copilot has the highest productivity and time saved among major tools (5.5 and 6.6 hours). Gemini has the lowest satisfaction (5.7). DeepSeek (9 users) and Meta AI (10 users) have samples too small for reliable conclusions.

3.7 Results by country

Canada (5.7), Pakistan (5.8) and Australia (5.6) report the highest productivity among countries with at least 20 respondents. Germany (4.7), Brazil (4.9) and the United Kingdom (5.0) report the lowest. Nigeria stands out: respondents there use AI heavily (4.0 hours a day, among the highest) yet report below-average productivity (4.8), which suggests heavy use is not translating into results and deserves a closer look. Kenya shows the strongest figures overall but has only 6 respondents, so it should not be treated as reliable.

3.8 Cost and willingness to recommend

- **Cost:** 47% of respondents with cost data (129 of 276) pay for AI tools. Free users report productivity of 5.4 against 5.1 for paying users, with practically identical time saved (5.8 and 5.9 hours). Correlation between cost and every outcome measure is close to zero.

- **Recommendation:** 60% would recommend their tool (170 respondents), 25% would not (71) and 15% are unsure (42). Students (61%) and professionals (59%) are almost identical. Those who say yes report higher productivity (5.7 against 4.2 for those who say no) and more time saved (6.5 against 4.7 hours).
- **Income and age:** Neither income nor age has a meaningful relationship with productivity or time saved. Older respondents show a slight tendency toward lower satisfaction (correlation of -0.12).

4. What the Findings Mean

1. **Depth of use is the main driver of benefit.** The strong relationship between hours of use, time saved and productivity suggests that occasional, shallow use captures only a fraction of what AI can offer. This should be read carefully, since people who find AI helpful may also choose to use it more (see Section 6).
2. **Tool choice is a secondary issue.** With small differences between mainstream tools, organizations and individuals gain more from improving how AI is used than from switching products.
3. **Accuracy limits trust.** Accuracy has almost no link with usage or productivity, but a clear link with satisfaction (correlation 0.52). People can be productive with AI while still being uneasy about reliability. With about half of respondents rating accuracy at 3 or below, verification and review habits are essential.
4. **Value is uneven across tasks.** Writing, office and research tasks deliver the largest time savings. Coding, the most common use, delivers the weakest satisfaction and productivity, which may reflect higher quality demands and more time spent checking output.
5. **Paying more is not a shortcut.** Premium spending shows no benefit in this dataset, so paid tiers should be justified by specific needs rather than assumed to be better.
6. **Context matters.** Country differences, especially the high-use but low-productivity pattern in Nigeria, point to local factors such as language support, connectivity or training that are not captured in the data.

5. Recommendations

Priority	Recommendation	Rationale
High	Run structured onboarding and practice programs for light users (under 2 hours a day), focused on real tasks. Track results before and after.	Half of respondents are light users and see the smallest gains; a pilot will also test whether the usage link is causal.
High	Introduce verification guidelines: fact-check key outputs, use sources, and review generated code before use.	Accuracy averages 3.4 out of 5 and is closely tied to satisfaction.
High	Prioritize AI deployment for writing, office work and research tasks first.	These show the highest time savings (about 7 hours a week).
Medium	Give coding users targeted training on prompting, testing and review workflows.	Coding has the lowest productivity and satisfaction despite being the most common use.
Medium	Start with free tools and approve paid subscriptions only through a role-based business case.	No measurable benefit from higher spending; free users report equal or better results.
Medium	Investigate low-productivity, high-use groups (for example Nigeria) through short interviews or	Heavy use is not producing gains, so local barriers may exist.

Priority	Recommendation	Rationale
	follow-up surveys.	
High	Improve data collection: use drop-down lists for tool, country, education and profession; validate numeric ranges; make key fields mandatory; state the currency.	Inconsistent labels and missing values currently weaken the analysis (see Section 6 and the appendix).
Medium	Build a simple tracking dashboard with five indicators: usage hours, time saved, productivity, accuracy and recommend rate.	Allows progress to be monitored consistently over time.

6. Limitations and Cautions

- **Self-reported data.** All scores are respondent opinions, not measured performance. Time saved in particular is an estimate.
- **Correlation is not causation.** Heavy users may report higher productivity because they are more enthusiastic about AI, not only because use raises productivity.
- **Uneven and small groups.** Some tools (DeepSeek, Meta AI) and countries (Kenya) have too few respondents for firm conclusions.
- **Data quality.** Missing values and outliers affect some figures (detailed in the appendix). Because of this, results should be read as indicative rather than precise.
- **Snapshot in time.** The survey does not show how benefits change as people gain experience.

7. Conclusion

The dataset shows that AI delivers meaningful, though not dramatic, benefits to both students and professionals, and that the size of the benefit rises sharply with the amount of regular use. The two main barriers are shallow adoption and concern about accuracy. Improving training, building verification habits, focusing on high-value tasks and tightening data collection will give the best return, while spending on premium tools should be approached with caution. A follow-up study with standardised questions, objective measures and larger samples per tool and country would strengthen these conclusions.

Appendix: Data Quality Notes

- **Missing values (out of 288 records):** Age 23, Tasks performed 17, Profession 14, Productivity score 14, Accuracy rating 14, Assistant purpose 13, Education level 12, Monthly cost 12, Country 10, AI tool 10, Monthly income 10, Time saved 10, Gender 9, Work or study hours 9.